

Rana Faraz Ahmed

Head of AI & Engineering Leader · CTO · AI/ML Architect

ranafarazahmed@gmail.com linkedin.com/in/ranafarazahmed github.com/ranafaraz

PROFILE

AI and engineering leader with 11+ years building and shipping production systems. A rare combination of hands-on AI/ML engineering, PMP-grade delivery leadership, and tech-law literacy (LLB, cyber/IP focus) — building AI that is defensible on data privacy, IP, and governance.

CORE SKILLS

AI / ML	LLMs, Generative AI, RAG, Recommender Systems, NLP, Deep Learning, MLOps, AI Agents, PyTorch, TensorFlow, LangChain, OpenAI API
Cloud & Platform	AWS, GCP, Kubernetes (GKE), Docker, CI/CD, Serverless, Solution Architecture
Engineering	Python, Node.js, React, Angular, Flutter, PHP/Laravel, Django, REST APIs, BigQuery, SQL & NoSQL
Leadership & Governance	Technical Leadership, AI Governance, Program/Project Management (PMP), Data Privacy & Compliance (FERPA/COPPA/GDPR)

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer, VP of Engineering & AI/ML Architect — Electus Global Education Co.

Full-time · Remote (Florida, US) · Feb 2025 – Present

- Define and own technology strategy, system architecture, and the engineering organization; lead teams building secure, high-performance, scalable platforms.
- Architect AI/ML personalization — NLP, deep learning, recommender systems, and RAG-based chatbots that match learner skills to career goals.
- Build AI-powered micro-tasking (“edu-jobs & rewards”) with gamified financial-literacy and career-readiness experiences.
- Own cloud and cybersecurity: high-availability AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, serverless; compliance with FERPA, COPPA, GDPR.
- Design blockchain-based digital credentials — verifiable badges and micro-certifications.

Product Owner & AI/ML Architect — Electus Global Education Co.

Part-time · Remote · Aug 2024 – Jan 2025

- Owned and prioritized the product backlog to deliver maximum value.
- Bridged stakeholders and engineering; set vision and aligned product with business goals.
- Spearheaded the AI/ML architecture for Electus.

Member, PMO Steering Committee — The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Part-time · Hybrid (Rahim Yar Khan, Pakistan) · Jan 2025 – Present

- Provide strategic direction and high-level governance for the project portfolio.
- Review/approve project charters, business cases, and change requests by impact, value and risk.
- Identify and mitigate critical program-level risks; report outcomes to top leadership.

Senior Project Manager — The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Full-time · Hybrid (Bahawalpur, Pakistan) · Dec 2021 – Jan 2025

- Managed HR, network, software and cloud infrastructure for ~100,000 daily active users across 5 sub-campuses.
- Supervised a 50+ person team; trained 1,000+ end users across departments.
- Delivered a 50M PKR CMS at 15% under budget and two weeks ahead of schedule.
- Delivered a budget-management program governing a 12 Billion PKR organizational budget.

Additional Director (BPS-19) — The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Part-time · Hybrid · Mar 2024 – Sep 2024

- Partnered with the Director to establish and expand a franchise network of schools and colleges.
- Led initiatives to widen educational access in Bahawalpur District.

Deputy Director (BPS-18) — The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Part-time · On-site · Dec 2022 – Mar 2024

- Oversaw all IT, procurement and administrative matters at the Islamia University School System.
- Streamlined operations and led cross-functional teams to deliver organizational goals.

Programmer (BPS-17) — The Islamia University of Bahawalpur

Contract · On-site · Jun 2020 – Nov 2021

- Led development of custom applications in PHP and JavaScript.
- Built an ERP solution; deployed iDempire ERP to automate procurement.

Business Analyst — Al-Wakeel Institute

Part-time · Hybrid · Mar 2024 – Jan 2026

- Mentored and directed business developers to grow the institute’s profile.
- Served as Brand Ambassador; brought in new partnerships and opportunities.

Project Manager — Dexterous Developers

Full-time · On-site (Rahim Yar Khan) · Jan 2017 – Jan 2020

- Led cross-functional teams of engineers, marketers and analysts to deliver projects.
- Managed the full lifecycle with Asana and Jira; mitigated risks and strengthened client relationships.

Software Engineer — [Aerezona Developers](#)

Full-time · On-site (Lahore) · Jan 2015 – Apr 2017

- Built and deployed web apps in PHP and JavaScript frameworks for international clients across the SDLC.
- Led development and launch of a complex LMS (+40% online sales).
- Introduced automated testing, reducing defects by 30%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- PhD in Computer Science — research: Data Science in Finance (thesis submitted)
- MPhil Computer Science
- LLB (Law) — Cyber, IP & Copyright law focus
- BS Computer Science
- PMP — Project Management Institute (PMI)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Ensemble Machine Learning Framework for PFAS Risk Screening in Public Water Systems — CMES – Computer Modeling in Engineering & Sciences (2026). Stacking ensemble; ROC-AUC 0.957.
- Collection of Autonomous System Level Topology Using Looking Glass Servers — Pakistan Journal of Science (2019). Discovered 378 new Autonomous Systems and 1,740 AS links.